



Grant Application for Funding

Program: Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Funding Program – Grants

(name of program to which you are applying for funding)

Completing the form

This is a standard form used by multiple programs at Employment and Social Development Canada (ESDC).

You must read the Applicant Guide that is specific to the program to which you are applying. Each funding program may have unique mandatory questions, priorities, or supporting documents to submit with the completed Application Form.

Unless otherwise indicated in the Applicant Guide or on this form, you must complete all parts of the Application Form. ESDC may refuse applications that are incomplete or contain errors. We will contact you to request any mandatory information if it is missing from your application form.

If a closing date is posted, you must submit your Application Form by that date. We will not accept applications received after a closing date.

This document includes the following sections:

Section A – Notice to Applicants

Section B – Application Form

Part 1 – Organization

Part 2 – Project Proposal

Part 3 – Budget

Part 4 – Attestation

How to submit the form and supporting documents

Consult the Applicant Guide for instructions on how to submit your application and supporting documents.

Section A – Notice to Applicants

Attestation

In order for your application to be eligible, you must have the authority:

- to submit project proposals for the applicant organization
- to enter into contracts and agreements on behalf of this organization
- to certify that the information in the application is true, accurate and complete

You must provide:

- your name
- your title
- the date

No signature is required.

Information in the form and supporting documents

The completion of this application form and provision of supporting documents is voluntary. Should you apply, note that there are some fields in the application form that are mandatory and required in order to submit a completed application. Please refer to the Applicant Guide for instructions.

We may also use or disclose your application information:

- to share information with others outside the government as a part of the review process
- for policy and research analysis

Note that these additional uses or disclosures of your personal information will not affect your relationship with this department or any other government organization.

Personal information

We ensure to manage personal information according:

- to the [Department of Employment and Social Development Act](#)
- to the [Privacy Act](#)
- other applicable laws

You have the right:

- to the protection of your personal information
- to access or change your personal information

If you have privacy concerns, contact the [Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada](#).

Access to information

Basic information on successful applications will be available on [Open Government](#).

Your application is also subject to the Access to Information Act (ATIA). The ATIA gives every person a right to access information under the department's control, except for some [exemptions](#).

Find [instructions for accessing this information](#). You can also visit a Service Canada Centre.

SECTION B – Part 1 – Organization**Organization Identification****1. Legal Name** (Organization's full name, as it appears on legal documents)

Ontario Co-operative Association Inc.

2. Operating Name (if different from legal name)

Ontario Co-operative Association

3. Year Established (Year the organization was created.)

2002

4. Organization Type
☒ Not-For-Profit ☐ Private Sector ☐ Public Sector
5. Organization Category - For example: Sector councils; University; Municipal Government; etc. (see Applicant Guide for more examples).

Not-for-profit sector

6. Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) Business Number - Unique 15-digit number assigned to your business or legal entity by CRA.

863064069RC0001

If you do not have a CRA Business Number, provide one of the following:

For example: Your provincial/territorial corporation number (such as the number found on your Letters Patent) or your federal corporation number with Industry Canada (see Applicant Guide for further details).

☐ Other Registration Number:

or

☐ I have provided a separate document confirming the proof of operations for my organization.

Specify type of document(s):

7. Organization Primary Address

Street number and name

45 Speedvale Ave. E, Unit 2

City or Town

Guelph

Province or Territory

Ontario

Postal Code

N1H 1J2

Country

Canada

Telephone Number and Ext.

(519) 763-6540

Email Address

jross@ontario.coop

8. Mailing Address - Is it the same as the Organization Primary Address?

☒ Yes ☐ No

9. Organization's Primary Activities In no more than 500 words describe your organization's primary activities.

The Ontario Co-operative Association supports individuals and groups wanting to build new or develop established co-operative businesses. We provide co-operatives with support and services in the areas of business development, advocacy and education, and create opportunities to unite, collaborate and celebrate as one voice and movement.

Local Food and Farm Co-operatives (LFFC) is a two-tier membership-based network dedicated to building sustainable food systems, equitable economies, and resilient communities across Ontario. Since 2009, LFFC has supported over 100 individuals, organizations, local food and farm co-operatives, and social enterprises. They provide organizing and development support for food and farming co-operatives, supporting their growth and collaboration. LFFC plays a crucial role in community economic development, supporting new farmers, and establishing new markets in the local food and agriculture sector.

The Northern Foodways Development Network (NFDN), an initiative of the Local Food and Farm Co-operative, is a Value Chain Coordination (VCC) entity. The Northern Foodways Development Network (NFDN) is a collaborative project connecting food leaders, innovators, and stakeholders in Northern Ontario. It aims to improve food-related outcomes for the region by serving as a hub for experts, resources, and information on resilient and sustainable foodways.

Select the target group(s) that best aligns with your organization's primary activities. You may select more than one option.
Note: your answer to this question will not impact the assessment of your project. (Optional)

☐ Select all groups

☐ Seniors

☒ Newcomers

☒ Visible Minorities

☐ Youth

☒ Women

☐ 2SLGBTQI+

☐ People with Disabilities

☒ Low Income

☒ Remote / Rural

☐ Individuals Experiencing Homelessness

☐ Official Language Minority Communities

☐ Indigenous (specify)

☐ First Nations

☐ Inuit

☐ Metis

☐ Urban/Non Affiliated

☐ Other (specify)

☐ Not Applicable

Organization Contacts

Primary Contacts - This should be your primary contact person with respect to this application for funding.

10. Given Name/Surname

Name:

Surname:

Jennifer

Ross

11. Position Title

Executive Director

12. Preferred language of communicationWritten: ☒ English ☐ FrenchSpoken: ☒ English ☐ French**13. Primary Contact - Address**☒ Same as Organization
Primary Address☐ Same as Organization
Primary Mailing Address☐ Different
(include below)**Secondary Contact** - This should be your secondary contact person with respect to this application for funding in case we cannot reach the primary contact.**14. Given Name/Surname**

Name:

Michelle

Surname:

Chin-Dawe

15. Position Title

Director, LFFC

16. Preferred language of communicationWritten: ☒ English ☐ FrenchSpoken: ☒ English ☐ French**17. Secondary Contact - Address**☐ Same as Organization
Primary Address☒ Same as Organization
Primary Mailing Address☐ Different
(include below)**18. Does your organization owe any amounts to the Government of Canada?**☐ Yes☒ No

If yes, complete the fields below for each amount owing.

Amount Owing	Nature of the amount owing (e.g. taxes, penalties, overpayments)	Department or agency to which amount is owed	19. If an amount is owing, is a payment plan in place?
A.			☐ Yes ☐ No
B.			☐ Yes ☐ No
C.			☐ Yes ☐ No
D.			☐ Yes ☐ No

SECTION B – Part 2 – Project Proposal**Project Proposal Identification****20. Project Title**

Growing Together: Fostering a co-operative Food Culture

21. Planned Project Start Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

2024-08-01

22. Planned Project End Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

2026-08-01

23. Amount requested from Employment and Social Development Canada

\$200,000.00

Project Proposal Description**24. Project Summary** In no more than 500 words, describe the need of the project including its goals, expected results, and the targeted group.

Our project aims to promote collaboration and shared experiences in the realm of food and farming, with a focus on advancing the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (UNSDGs) within the local food, farm, co-op and social enterprise sector. Through a series of workshops, regional roundtables, and online resources, we aim to increase awareness of the UNSDGs, provide practical guidance for co-ops and social enterprises to integrate the SDGs into their operations, and strengthen partnerships within the sector.

The need for this project arises from the lack of awareness of the UNSDGs within the local food and farm co-op sector. By raising awareness and providing tools for integration, we aim to empower co-ops and local food and farm actors to see themselves as leaders in climate action and sustainability. The project objectives are as follows:

1. Increase awareness and understanding of the UNSDGs among local food and farm co-op members. We will achieve this by organizing a workshop that engages our membership/network and showcases the role of the sector in advancing the SDGs.
2. Provide practical guidance and tools for local food and farm businesses or co-ops to advance the SDGs. We will create a toolkit on how to integrate the SDGs into their operations, which will be accessible through an online platform like Mighty Networks.
3. Strengthen partnerships and networks between the Ontario Co-operative Association (OCA), Local Food and Farm Co-op (LFFC), Northern Foodways Development Network (NFDN), and their memberships/netowkrs. To achieve this, we will organize regional round tables to facilitate dialogue, collaboration, and knowledge-sharing on achieving the SDGs within the local food and farm sector.

The expected outputs of this project include a workshop aimed at engaging our membership/network on the UNSDGs, a toolkit on advancing SDGs in food farm businesses or co-ops, and media cards and info-graphics to increase awareness on the UNSDGs and the impact of local food and farm co-ops. The outcomes we anticipate include the establishment or strengthening of partnerships and networks within the sector, enhanced multi-disciplinary efforts through engagement with Canada's wider food sector, and the identification and development of resources to help communities effectively implement the SDGs.

Our project aligns with the objectives of the funding program by increasing public awareness of the UNSDGs within equity-deserving groups and vulnerable populations. We also contribute to fostering new and established partnerships

by bridging efforts across sectors in support of the 2030 Agenda. Specifically, our project targets SDGs 2 (Zero Hunger), 3 (Good Health and Well-being), 5 (Gender Equality), 10 (Reduced Inequalities), 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production), 13 (Climate Action), and 17 (Partnerships for the Goals).

Through this project we aim to empower co-ops and local food and farm actors to play an active role in advancing the UNSDGs, creating sustainable and equitable food systems, and building a stronger social economy. By fostering collaboration and raising awareness, we believe that our project will contribute to positive change in individuals' relationships with food and their overall well-being.

25. Program Objective and Priorities In no more than 500 words, describe how the project meets the objective(s) and/or priority(ies) of the funding program.

Objective 1: Increase awareness and understanding of the UNSDGs among local food and farm co-op members through our "Collective Digital Content Marketing Program." We will achieve this by organizing a workshop that engages our membership/networks and showcases the role of the sector in advancing the SDGs.

Local leaders play a crucial role in driving positive change within their communities. Through the SDG Digital Content Marketing Program, we will collaborate with transactional actors and support actors to simplify complex ideas and foster a common understanding, shared purpose, and alignment. This program will raise awareness of local leaders who are working towards the SDGs, creating social, cultural, environmental, and economic impact in their communities.

Capture high-quality photos, b-roll, and reels to raise awareness and recognize local leaders. Develop digital content marketing strategies through social media marketing, email marketing, online marketing, and SEO. Launch online marketing campaigns on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and LinkedIn (+Mighty networks) to create awareness of local leaders working towards the SDGs.

Objective 2: Provide practical guidance and tools for local food and farm businesses or co-ops to advance the SDGs. We will create a toolkit on how to integrate the SDGs into their operations, which will be accessible through an online platform like Mighty Networks.

LFFC and NFDN have an online peer-to-peer network on Mighty Networks that we have used to disseminate our online courses. Through this platform, we will create a toolkit on how local food, farms, and co-ops can integrate the SDGs. The toolkit will be developed as part of Objective 1 through the Collective Digital Content Marketing Program and then shared on Mighty Networks.

Objective 3: Strengthen partnerships and networks between the Ontario Co-operative Association (OCA), Local Food and Farm Co-op (LFFC), Northern Foodways Development Network (NFDN), and their membership/networks. To achieve this, we will organize regional round tables to facilitate dialogue, collaboration, and knowledge-sharing on achieving the SDGs within the local food and farm sector.

The Northern Foodways Development Network (NFDN) and Local Food and Farm Co-op (LFFC) aim to provide representation and a voice to the diverse regions, people, and places of Ontario. By engaging stakeholders through a community engagement strategy, we promote the concept of community sufficiency and collaborative empowerment within our regions.

We bring together transactional actors and support actors to learn from each other and define common goals and a shared vision to address social, cultural, environmental, and economic challenges within the food system.

26. Project Activities and Timelines (Provide the activities and their timelines that will be taking place as part of this project.)

Activities	Timelines	
Host 4 Round tables in Northeastern Ontario, Northwestern Ontario, Central and Southern Ontario focused on identifying key challenges, gaps, barriers, and opportunities to advancing SDGs.	August 2024 - December 2024	
Identify local leaders and stories of success to amplify through media.	September 2024 - January 2026	
Create cards, info-graphics, campaigns to increase awareness of SDGs. Use storytelling to simplifying complex ideas and foster common understanding on how to advance SDGs.	January 2025 - January 2026	
Workshops on the role of the food and farm sector in advancing SDGs	February 2025 - June 2025	
Guide/Toolkit on how food and farm co-ops can advance SDGs	February 2025 - September 2025	
Workshops on how food and farm co-ops can advance SDGs and integrate into operations.	September 2025 - January 2026	
Host 4 Round tables in Northeastern Ontario, Northwestern Ontario, Central and Southern Ontario facilitating dialogue, collaboration, knowledge sharing, support on advancing SDGs.	January 2026 - August 2026	
Identify common SDG impacts to monitor/measure and communicate within the value chain and local food systems.	January 2026 - August 2026	

27. Will your organization deliver any of the project activities at its primary address?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Will your organization deliver project activities in a different location from your primary address?

☐ Yes ☒ No

28. Will the project or any of its activities involve or benefit people in English or French linguistic minority communities in Canada, in some way?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ Not Applicable

29. Is your project targeting vulnerable groups?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, select the specific target group(s) that applies to your project.

☐ Select all groups

☐ Seniors

☒ Newcomers

☒ Visible Minorities

☐ Youth

☒ Women

☐ 2SLGBTQI+

☐ People with Disabilities

☒ Low Income

☒ Remote / Rural

☐ Individuals Experiencing
Homelessness

☐ Official Language
Minority Communities

☐ Indigenous (specify)

☐ First Nations

☐ Inuit

☐ Metis

☐ Urban/Non Affiliated

☐ Other (specify)

SECTION B – Part 3 – Budget**30. Project Cost - (expenses) for the eligible activities or services of the proposed project**

List each eligible activity or service:	Cost is: Cash or Cost is: Donation (in-kind)	Cost (\$ value)
Administration/Bookkeeping (Salary)	☒ ☐	\$20,000.00
South-Central Coordinator (Contractor)	☒ ☐	\$85,000.00
Northern Coordinator (Contractor)	☒ ☐	\$85,000.00
Networking Platform	☒ ☐	\$3,000.00
Event & Travel	☒ ☐	\$7,000.00
Graphic Design/IT/Digital Systems	☒ ☐	\$15,000.00
Sector + Co-op Expertise	☐ ☒	\$10,000.00
	☐ ☒	
	☐ ☒	
Total cost of eligible activities and/or services*		\$225,000.00

31. Funding Sources - (revenues) for the proposed project costs noted above

List Organization Name for each Funding Source (can be other governments, a private sector organization, or self-funded)	Funding amount is: Cash or Funding amount is: Donation (in-kind)	Funding Amount (\$ value)	Funding amount is: Confirmed (guaranteed)
Amount requested from Employment and Social Development Canada**		\$200,000.00	
St. James Town Community Co-op	☒ ☐	\$15,000.00	☒
Local Food and Farm Co-op	☐ ☒	\$10,000.00	☒
	☐ ☐		☐
	☐ ☐		☐
	☐ ☐		☐
	☐ ☐		☐
	☐ ☐		☐
	☐ ☐		☐
Total funding for eligible activities or services*		\$225,000.00	

* Total cost in Question 30 and total funding in question 31 must be equal.

Budget Details

32. Use this field to provide any further budget details that you may find necessary in describing your project. (This field is optional if you want to provide more information.)

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Section B – Part 4 – Attestation

In order for your application to be eligible, an official representative who has the capacity and the authority to submit project proposals and enter into contracts and agreements on behalf of your organization must complete this section of the form. By doing so, you are attesting to the following three points:

- I have the capacity and the authority to submit this Application for Funding on behalf of the applicant organization
- I certify and warrant on behalf of the organization and in my personal capacity that the information provided in this Application for Funding and any supporting documentation is true, accurate, and complete
- I have read the Applicant Guide and understand the program's requirements

Official Representative Name (print)	
Title (print)	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
Official Representative Name (print)	
Title (print)	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
Official Representative Name (print)	
Title (print)	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)